

THEME	Top-level category	2nd level	3rd level	4th level	Description	Examples
NARRATIONAL	[Settings]	<i>The landscapes, locations, and atmospheres described — spanning real-world places, imagined worlds, natural environments, and the qualities and aesthetics of a scene.</i>				
		[Natural World]	<i>Non-human and non-built environments, encompassing flora, fauna, landforms, weather, and celestial phenomena.</i>			
			Creatures		real, mythological, or fantastical creatures and any descriptions of them.	dogs, centaur, dinosaurs, dragon, unicorn, rabbit-like creature, fluffy, scary, vicious, tame, wild
			Terrains		physical formations of geographic and natural landscape features of the Earth's surface.	canyons, desert, tundra, rolling hills, forest, prairie, mountains, valleys
			Vegetation		flora and plant life, in natural or symbolic contexts.	wildflowers, palm trees, wheat, weeping willow, roses, ivy
			Sky and Space		celestial, cosmic, or atmospheric elements above or beyond Earth.	clouds, sun, sunrise, moon, stars, moonlight, aurora borealis, galaxies, black holes
			Water Features		bodies of water, water-related natural features, and aquatic phenomena.	rivers, ocean, pond, underwater, waves, rapids
			Weather		atmospheric and seasonal weather conditions shaping the environment.	rainfall, fog, snowy, stormy, wind
		Fictional and Spiritual Settings			invented or otherworldly locations from fantasy, myth, science fiction, dystopian imagination, or spiritual and symbolic realms.	enchanted forest, far away land, virtual world, futuristic city, alien world, post-apocalyptic scene, heaven, hell, otherworldly
		Societal Places			constructed, inhabited, or socially oriented settings — from private domestic spaces to public venues, institutions, infrastructures, and culturally significant sites.	kitchen, garage, yard, my grandma's house, pub, cafe, nightclub, stadium, theatre, spa, school, office, hospital, factory, airport, highway, subway station, roads, bridge, cathedral, temple, monastery
		Named Regional Places			specific, named real-world locations at any geographic scale — from landmarks and venues to cities, countries, and continents.	Times Square, White Cliffs of Dover, Studio 54, Stubb's Bar-B-Q, Sahara, Monument Valley, Amazon Rainforest, Italy, Liverpool, New York, Asia, Latin America
		Scene Qualities			the mood, tone, aesthetic, and stylistic feel of a setting, as well as its perceived scale or density.	dreary, serene, ominous, romantic, mysterious; vast, crowded, small, deserted; dreamy, filmic, trippy, aesthetic of ..., French (when describing the aesthetic of a place)
		Spatial Orientation			the concrete placement or perspective of people and things in a scene, often relative to the viewer or narrator.	above me, beside her, around us, in the distance, out a door
	[Characters]	<i>References to all real and fictional people, named and not named, including descriptions such as identity, traits, appearance, roles, relations, and amount of people.</i>				
		[Character Descriptors]	<i>Ways people are described as individuals or types, through identity markers, roles, traits, clothing, or social groups.</i>			
			[Outfit Details]	<i>References to clothing, style, and presentation through dress.</i>		
				Accessories	wearable items that are not primary clothing.	hat, necklace, gloves, leg warmers, sunglasses
				Hair	references to hair styles, textures, lengths, colours, and other distinctive features of hair.	afro, red head, curly, blonde, bald
				Outfit Descriptors		dress, tshirt, trousers, pants, shoes, 80s, casual, funky, fancy, formal, gothic, ragged, retro
			Identity		labels for social categories, backgrounds, and collective identities.	African Americans, Arabic, female, gay, white, youth, Gen-X, yuppies, aristocrats, bikers, punks, hippies, metal heads, rockers, beatniks
			Professions and Pursuits	Music-related Professions and Pursuits	roles tied to occupation, labour, hobbies, or performance identities.	actor, dancer, detective, bartender, cowboy, soldier, scientist, stripper, trucker, TikTokr, athlete, farmer, monk
					sub-category of “Professions and Pursuits” for the code density of music-related references.	guitarist, drummer, choir director, singer, producer
			Relations		references to familial, romantic, or friendship ties that situate individuals in relation to others through kinship or close social bonds.	mom, dad, siblings, grandma, grandparents, friends, mates,
			Archetypes		stock figures, genre roles, symbolic character types, and functional roles in narratives or myths.	heroine, villain, femme fatale, prince charming, spy, killer, antagonist, final boss
			Social Collectives		people grouped collectively or generically by activity, style, or setting.	audience, congregation, citizens, clubbers, beach-goers, spectators, students, guests, fans, coworkers
			Traits		adjectives and emotion-based descriptions of an individuals' qualities or conditions.	aging, anxious, cool, drug addled, gothy, high, mournful, rugged, wise, young, too busy, she has dementia, dead, deceased
		[Named Figures]	Creators		real-world individuals known for their creative and artistic authorship — those who shape or originate works rather than perform them.	Alfred Hitchcock, Makoto Shinakai, Baz Luhrman, J.R.R. Tolkien, Jane Austen
			Fictional Characters		named characters and non-human entities from stories across literature, film, TV, games, or other narrative media.	Batman, Barbie, Big Bird, Goku, Gordon Freeman, Link, Romeo, Wile E. Coyote, hobbitts, Minions, stormtroopers, Seamoth (Subnautica)
			Historical and Mythical Figures		named real-world or legendary figures outside contemporary celebrity, including religious and mythological figures.	the Royal Family, Napoleon, Santa Claus, angel Michael, Ba'al, devil
			Performers and Entertainers		real-world individuals known for their performance, public presence, or entertainment value across stage, screen, music, or digital platforms.	Audrey Hepburn, Dick Van Dyke, Uma Thurman, Morgan Freeman, David Copperfield, the Rat Pack, Jimmy Fallon, Caroline Girvan
		[Social Presence]	<i>descriptions of how figures are socially situated or configured in relation to others, from states of togetherness to solitude.</i>			
			Solitude		situations where a figure is explicitly described as alone.	all alone, lone, nobody, solo, themself, without imagining a person
			Dyads		a figure with exactly one other person, whether intimate, familial, adversarial, or situational.	alone with them, next to her, with a friend, with a loved one, with a parent, with my sibling, with the antagonist, with the woman I love
			Groups		references to being with multiple people, in familial, social, or public group contexts.	with family, with mates, with a bunch of friends, with a ton of strangers, with people
		Body Parts			literal anatomical references, detached from personality or social identity.	eyes, face, fist, foot, hand, fingers, legs, flesh, brain
	[Objects & Things]	<i>References to non-living entities, items, and materials — including consumables, built objects, decor, transport, and descriptive qualities, descriptions of objects, and institution-related articles.</i>				
		Consumables			edible, drinkable, or intoxicating items for human consumption.	a meal, pasta, popcorn, meatloaf, sugar puffs, candy, ice cream, coffee, soda, tea, beer, wine, whisky, weed, acid, ecstasy, mushrooms, coke
		Everyday Objects			items, furnishings, tools, and entertainment objects commonly found in homes or personal daily environments.	sofa, desk, staircase, toilet, throne, blanket, candles, washing powder, curtains, disco balls, balloons, pinball, puzzles, gun, torch, weights, machinery, phones, artwork, projector, monitors, statue, letters, notes, Newton's cradle, isolation tank, Gravitron
		Transport			all real or imagined modes of transport, including vehicles, vessels, features, and modifications.	muscle car, Ferrari 250 GTO, taxi, truck, motorbike, bicycles, bus, trains, tram, ship, yacht, submarine, biplane, helicopter, rocket, UFO, hovercraft, horse and carriage, slammed, roof down, hydraulics, wipers.
		Commerce and Organisations			entities tied to organisations, commerce, and symbolic representation, including logos, money, corporate identities, and institutional references.	icons, logos, money, product, HMRC phone line, NBA, GEICO, National Trust
		Materials and Surfaces			substances and textures describing what objects are made of and how they feel or appear.	silk, linen, voile, marble, sandstone, cobblestone, chrome, iron, wooden, mirrored, glittery, polished
		Object Qualities			descriptive modifiers of objects, including scale, condition, age, style, prestige, and aesthetic feel.	massive, lots of, old fashioned, dilapidated, art deco, gothic, retro, Victorian, expensive, luxury, majestic, sleek, greasy, jagged, funky, whimsical, strange, weird, cheesy
	[Agentic Actions]	<i>Encompasses all “doing” words—actions, behaviours, process, and motion—by humans and non-humans, including qualifiers and verb modifiers.</i>				
			<i>Purposive, goal-directed behaviours, often propelling narrative development.</i>			

	[Actions]		Directed Movement		arrival & departure, travel & journeys, walking & roaming, vertical & directional shifts.	leaving, walk, move away, driving to, coming out, showing up,
			Daily life		practical, routine, and labour connected to domestic life and work tasks, including physical and mental efforts.	errands, cleaning, vacuuming, putting children to bed, studying, living their day to day, hustling, lifting
			Music-linked Movement		physical movement tied to rhythm, musical accompaniment, or expressive bodily response to sound.	dance, boogie, hop, head banging, swaying, rocking out, in the groove, throwing off the shackles, moshing
			Sports		physical activities and sport done for fitness, skill, challenge, or play, that is not dance.	aerobics, yoga, hiking, rafting, parkour, surfing
			Creating and Performing		artistic, expressive, or intellectual output, including casual and formal creative practices.	jamming, record, rehearsing, drawing, choreographing, inventing
			Relational and Social		socially orientated and reciprocal behaviours of communication and engagement.	advice, arguing, chat, cheering, flirting, giving me (from someone), mingling, seduce, speaking, teaching, telling
			Consuming		acts of consuming food, drink, or substances including intoxicants and supplements.	eating, sipping, smoking, taking pre-workout
			Conflict and Wrongdoing		acts of aggression, violence, deceit, or moral/legal transgression, including physical, verbal, or social harm directed toward people, animals, or property.	abuse, crime, conning, theft, murder, killing, fighting, trickery, harming animals
		[Processes and States]	<i>Attentional, resting, processual, and temporal states of being.</i>			
			Perceptual Acts		one-sided focus, noticing, or gaze-related acts.	gazing, listening, looking, watching, wanted her attention
			Non-directional Motions		actions that don't suggest directed movement towards or away from something, but refer to a motion that something or someone does.	drifting, dripping, blowing, floating, flowing,
			Rest and Leisure		physical postures, states of inactivity, relaxation, or low-effort enjoyment, including both stillness and casual recreation.	drifting off, in my chair, lay, lounging, seated, standing, bent over, upside down, waking up, taking a nap, gaming, shopping, clubbing, cruising, browsing
			Transforming and Learning		processes of change, development, or adaptation, whether physical, emotional, cognitive, or symbolic.	breakthrough (knowledge), discovered, integrate, learn, pursue (learning), reclaiming, solving, trying to (...), turning into, melting, exploding, malfunctioning
			Waiting and Anticipating		activities that involve readiness, expectation, or delay before an action or event.	getting ready, awaiting, anticipating
		[Action Modifiers]	<i>Adverbs that qualify and recalibrate scene animation.</i>			
			Speed		references to how fast or slow an action or motion occurs.	quickly, slowly, hurriedly, instantly, sluggishly
			Characterisation		qualities describing the specific character or manner of a movement, often reflecting personality or attitude.	confidently, gracefully, casually, flamboyantly, aggressively, angrily, joyfully, playfully, sadly
	[Music & Sounds]	<i>References to music, sound, and auditory experience — spanning instruments, creators, playback, qualities, functions, and non-musical sound events.</i>				
		Instruments, Ensembles, and Imitations			physical instruments, parts and accessories, voice types, musical groups, and pretend playing of instruments.	saxophone, drums, theremin, orchestra, marching band, choir, duet, singer, vocalist, a cappella, bow, brushes, baton, pedals, MIDI, air guitar, pretending to play drums
		Music Use and Function				before going to sleep, song for chores, start my day, for the soul, get out of the sad feeling, to try to quit smoking, helps me relax, gets you pumped, useful for deep thinking, to maintain a buzz, for a love, sending a message, meant to distract fans from misery, sell a product, music makes unpleasant things tolerable, leading to a looser pocket, to keep you in a trance, usually signal marching
		Sound Qualities	Music Genre, Cultural, and Stylistic Labels		contexts, purposes, and effects of music in daily life, ritual, commerce, or symbolic use.	well known, biggest hit, calming, soothing, melancholic, spooky, uplifting, celebratory, dramatic, whimsical, upbeat, energetic, lively, bouncy
					descriptions of how music or sound feels, is judged, or conveys mood, energy, or aesthetic character.	RnB, jazz, EDM, disco, metal, house, lo-fi, funk, new wave, old-school, grungy, indie, jazzy, funky, African, Arabic, Jewish, Scandi, Karaoke song, Hold music, Elevator music
		Sound Qualities	Technical and Structural Music Elements		named categories, stylistic markers, or cultural associations used to classify music.	driving beat, beat drop, crescendo, tempo builds up, modulated, distorted, repetitive, improvising, instrumental section, intro (referring to music)
					references to compositional, rhythmic, or performance-based aspects of sound arrangement.	cassettes, tape, records, vinyl, CDs, boombox, console stereo, jukebox, gramophone, car radio, radio station, channels, Hi-Fi, amps, headphones, earphone
		Playback and Listening Devices			devices and media formats through which music and sound are stored, transmitted, and heard.	Nina Simone, Prince, Linkin Park, Debussy, Tchaikovsky, Stranvinsky, Avicii, Delia Derbyshire, Ol' Blue Eyes (Frank Sinatra stage name), the Rat Pack
		Named Artists and Musicians			specific musicians, composers, singers, bands, or collectives.	Sweet Dreams, Enter Sandman, Take On Me, The Girl From Ipanema, "sweet dreams are made of this", "blue Christmas without you", "shock me like an electric eel"
		Named Songs and Lyrics			named songs, lyric fragments, and explicit reference to song text.	barking, chirping, jungle noises, footsteps, rustling, beeping, sirens, foghorn, revving, alarm, ringtone, games console startup, boom, pow, crash, clomping, pounding, blasting, laughter, growl, deep voice, religious chanting, sound effects, special effects, commotion, noises, silence
		Sounds and Sound Effects			non-musical auditory events, environmental noises, voices, or sound effects.	
REFERENTIAL	[Media, Art, & Technology]	<i>References to any type of media, artistic, entertainment, and technological domains — including formats, platforms, works, and techniques.</i>				
		Media Formats				musical, sitcom, talk show, advert, TV, documentary, news broadcast, RPG, MMO, side-scroller, arcade, music video, instructional video, pixel art, anime, bad graphics, VHS, comic book, video tape, anime art style, storyboard
		Media genres and styles			classifications of media by delivery format.	Bollywood, thriller, romance, comedy, blockbuster, period piece/drama, silent film, detective show, children's TV, soap opera, RPG, MMO, side-scroller, arcade, racing, boss fight, pixel art, anime, black-and-white, bad graphics, feel-good, gritty, cheesy, tacky, iconic, old-fashioned, black-and-white storyboard
		Media packaging structures			paratextual framing and structural devices used in the presentation of stories or media, especially framing and transitional elements.	opening credits, intro sequence, cliffhanger, outro, plot, cutscenes, montage, "behind the scenes", titles
		Media techniques and effects			production and presentation methods, including camera work, editing styles, and visual effects.	close-up, wide shot, panning, fade-out, green screen, CGI, drone shots, panoramic, sped up, film grain, reveal, sweeping shots
		Music and sound in media			audio elements in media, including soundtracks, diegetic sound, and narrative voice.	soundtrack, OST, theme tune, TV intro music, boss fight music, montage track, monologues, narration, voiceover, no dialogue
		Media companies and Devices			named corporations, studios, publishers, brands, streaming services, and hardware associated with media production and consumption.	Disney, Pixar, Hasbro, Sierra, Atari, Sega, Nintendo, Warner Bros, Casio, DS, PlayStation, Wii, SNES, Commodore 64, game console, Spotify, CRT TV, HD TV, television set, VR headset
		Digital platforms and Applications			online environments, apps, and technological tools for digital communications, creativity, or AI-mediated interaction.	apps, Mindful (app), Music Maker JAM, meditation apps, gif, meme, FMV meme, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, see this a lot on socials, AI-generated, Alexa (voice-command speaker)
		Named media references			explicit references to specific works, titles, franchises, or recognisable elements such as quotes, objects, and settings from media works.	Blade Runner, Star Wars, Sesame Street, BBC-Proms, Stranger Things, Zelda, Animal Crossing, Minecraft, Dune, Les Misérables, Swan Lake, Dungeons & Dragons, Warhammer 4K, "A long time ago in a galaxy far, far away...", Gotham, Naboo, the Shire, Namek, holodeck, Super Saiyan, League Pass (NBA live TV)
		<i>References to time, temporality, and happenings — from the scale of daily markers to major historical events and narrative structures.</i>				
		Events and Occasions			specific gatherings, ceremonies, rituals, or social happenings that mark an event in time.	party, wedding, funeral, concert, festival, sports match, theatre show, parade, dates, class, exam, therapy session, graduation, religious ceremony, disco

	[Chronology & Events]	Historical events and periods			large-scale eras, decades, centuries, or significant historical moments with cultural identity or context.	1920s, Renaissance, Swinging Sixties, wartime, golden age, prohibition, 1700s, 20th century, "back in the day," Vietnam War, World Wars, ancient times, early-2000s
		Narrative Progression			thematic and emotional beats that chart the unfolding of a story (fictional or lived), including shifts, climaxes, and resolutions.	beginnings, endings, climax build-ups, pivotal scenes, tragic moments, triumph, loss, revelations, realisations, impending doom, heartbreak
		Passage and Repetition of Time			references to duration, frequency, recurrence, and passing of time, including endurance and time-travel notions.	all day, all night, every single time, seen it so many times, plays everyday, a million times, few days ago, years ago, passing time, timer set, time travelling
		Seasons and Time			temporal markers within daily cycles, seasonal rhythms, and holidays as reference-points.	morning, afternoon, night, midnight, dusk, dawn, twilight, bedtime, after work, after school, 3am, Christmas, Halloween, Autumn, Winter, weekend
EXPERIENTIAL	[Symbolic & Sensory Representations]	Abstract, figurative, and sensory (real or imagined) dimensions of experience — spanning metaphors, values, and perceptual details.				
		[Sensory Details]	Perceptual and bodily details describing how things are sensed — either literally or imaginatively.			
			[Visual Details]	Colour	direct references to colours or palettes.	amber, neon, muted, black & white
				Illumination	descriptions of brightness, lighting, or visual effects created by illumination sources and their absence.	glow, spotlights, candlelit, lasers, strobe, moonlight, total darkness
				Text	written or projected words, quotes, or symbolic text as a visible element.	text on screen, words, titles, quotes, projected text
				Vantage Point	perspective or focal orientation of the viewer or scene.	the focus is on, aerial view, vantage point, up close, everywhere you look
				Oddities, Effects, Shapes, Patterns	stylised or abstract visual phenomena, unusual imagery, illusions, and motion patterns.	fractals, kaleidoscope, swirls, shapes, patterns, waves, cascade, checkerboard, psychedelic visuals, blurry images, reflections, pixelations, mechanical imagery, (any other abstract description like saxophones blowing bubbles)
			Smell		odours, scents, and aromatic qualities that set an atmosphere.	incense, scent, smoky, fills the air, I can smell the ...
			Bodily Sensation		physical sensations and tactile experiences, both external and visceral.	warm, cold, breeze, goosebumps, heartbeat, sun on face, wet, damp, hair blowing in the wind, tremors
		Conceptual and Metaphorical References			symbolic ideas, cultural and ideological abstractions, and metaphorical frames of meaning.	aesthetics, divinity, escapism, faith, harmony, health, holiday spirit, hope, lifestyle, love/love lost, magic, rage, rock culture, romance, subliminal messages, vibes, violence, itchy trigger fingers, up to their ankles in —, hellfire, fire and brimstone
	[Subjective & Personal Experience]	How people react to, evaluate, and connect with music in terms of personal feelings, opinions, and meaningful links to people and times in their life.				
		Emotions and Affective States			immediate emotional or mood-based states described in vivo, often affectively coloured words or phrases.	anxious, calm, nostalgic, angry, peaceful, in awe, in love, "that feeling you have", "flooded" (with emotion), calming thoughts, eerie, suspenseful, uplifting, oppressive, soothing, bittersweet, cozy, unsettling
		Opinions and Preferences			judgments, likes and dislikes, and other taste-related stances evaluating the music itself.	I liked/loved/hated, not my cup of tea, fan of, favourite song, "not music", spoiled it, good, great, awful, boring, pleasant, not appealing, wouldn't bother (listening), put up with it, inspires nothing, wanted it to end quickly, loved this band, saves the clip
		Personal Significance			references where music takes on a symbolic, identity-based, relational, or spiritual meaning beyond immediate enjoyment.	reminds me of her, my happy place, connected to, meaningful to me, our family piano, all praise to God, RIP, things get better, trying to find my way, your favourite song is on its way
		Personal Time-linked Connections			connections where music is explicitly tied to life stages, personal memories, and other temporally anchored experiences.	childhood, teenage years, when I was young, at 10 years old, first concert, my club days, "my mom is alive", "things will never be as they were", took me back, lazy days, "reclaiming the peace you had before"